

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

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Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

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CFO-RC FILE X: ?

RESULTS: ?

Species:(Common Name) Tri-colored Heron

(Scientific Name) Egretta tricolor

Date(s) of occurrence: June 28, 2000

Number of birds seen: one

Sex: Unknown

Plumage: Summer (non-breeding)

Exact location: Russell Lakes State Wildlife Area

County: Saguache

Nearest town: Saguache

Elevation: 7580ft.

Length of observation: 30 min.

Time(s) of observation: 0715 - 0745

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Larry Lowe

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): Rich Levad

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Bright, behind and to the left, shortly after sunrise.

Optical equipment used: 10x50 Nikon binoculars

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 50 yards

Was bird(s) photographed? No

If so, have you submitted photos? N/A

Who took the photographs? N/A

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Tall emergent wetland impoundment, on edge of bullrush patch in open water.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): Feeding in shallow water.

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes): The bird was feeding with a small group of snowy egrets when I saw it. This helped me compare the sizes between species. It was approximately 25 - 28 inches in length. I noticed a white strip that curved around the front of the wing, down to the belly. The bird was not in full breeding plumage. When the bird sprang in to flight, it extended it's neck out raveling a long neck. It had a long slender yellow bill.

Describe bird's call or song: No song or call was detected.

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: Only similar species were the Great Blue Heron and the Black-crowned Night-Heron. I eliminated the Great Blue due to the smaller size of the bird, and the presence of a white strip that curved around the front of the wing extending down to the belly. I eliminated the Black-crowned Night-Heron due to the longer neck of the bird, and the bird had a longer, slender, yellow bill. Also the plumage color of the bird was different from the Night-Heron.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I am very familiar with the Great Blue and Black-crowned Night Heron due to my employment at Russell Lakes State Wildlife Area. I also have been trained in proper identification of birds.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation):

National Geographic Society Field Guide to the Birds of North America.

This report is from notes made during ☒ or after ☒ observation or later ☒ from memory

Date of written report: August 6, 2000

Reporting observer: Dean C. Lee

Signature:

Reporting Observer's Address: 12464 Johnson Rd.

City: Alamosa

State: CO

Zip: 81101

Send report to:
Colorado Birds Record Committee
c/o Bill Lisowsky
2919 Silverplume Dr.
Ft. Collins, Co. 80526